

- Have respect for the person you're talking to.
- Don't make idle threats or wild claims.
- Be brief. No one wants to read *War and Peace*. Get to the point in one page or less.
- If you need to provide proof, keep copies or better yet, send copies.
- Keep a copy of your letter. You may need to reference it later.
- Avoid generalizations. Be specific about the one incident.
- Be honest. Really, only complain if you have a real complaint.

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### Nice feedback is also appreciated

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As I said earlier, the customer service folks are on the receiving end of some pretty nasty calls

and letters for most of their workday. So imagine their reaction when they get a letter or call that is simply a note of thanks for a great product or service. Not only does it make them feel good about their company, it also has more chance of making it higher up the corporate ladder. Who knows, it may even get to the CEO, and you may find yourself getting something in return for your kind words. It's not uncommon for nice feedback to result in a T-shirt, gift voucher, pen, or free product that you like so much. So, next time you eat a really tasty meal or are knocked out by the quality of service somewhere, think about letting that company know. It's a win-win situation for everyone.

— Paul Michael